



The background image shows a person in a dark blue business suit and white shirt, holding a pen and pointing at a glowing digital interface. The interface features a bar chart with blue bars, a line graph with a blue line, and various data points and percentages (52%, 64%, 85%) in circular icons. The overall theme is business and technology.

ENVIRONMENTAL FACTORS AND ENTREPRENEURSHIP DEVELOPMENT

Edited by:
Joshua Adewale Adejuwon
Godwin Emmanuel Oyedokun

Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development

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**Joshua Adewale Adejuwon
Godwin Emmanuel Oyedokun**

2023

Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development

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PREFACE

Entrepreneurship supports economic growth and development through market innovations and there is a bi-directional relationship between entrepreneurship and economic growth and development. Key constraints include the cost of starting a business and minimum paid-in capital requirements, with women entrepreneurs facing additional hurdles. Moreover, most of Africa's entrepreneurs are "necessity driven" rather than "opportunity-driven". Environmental factors in business are the conditions that exist in a business environment. The major environmental factors in business are technological factors, economic factors, social factors, political factors, and cultural factors.

This book brings together, the ideas of different Scholars, Practitioners, and Authorities concerning the subject matter, Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development. There are 13 chapters which were jointly contributed by 25 scholars in the field with the range of title such as Corporate Social Responsibility and Organizational Survival; Environmental Factors and Performance of Small-Scale Businesses in Shomolu Local Government, Lagos; Government Policies and Entrepreneurial Development in Nigeria; Organizational Culture and Business Performance in the Nigerian Service Sector; Sustainability of Small and Medium Scale Enterprises in Nigeria: The Role of Government Policies; Role of Entrepreneurship in Achieving Economic Growth in Nigeria; Impact of Macroeconomics Fluctuation on the Growth of Small and Medium Scale Businesses in Nigeria; Workforce Diversity and Organisational Productivity in Unilever; Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development in Nigeria; Green Marketing and Environmental Degradation in Lagos State, Nigeria; Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development in Nigeria; Significance of Interest Rate in Bolstering Business Development in Nigeria; and Corporate Social Responsibility on Business Growth in Business Environment. This edited book is an addition to the frontiers of knowledge in business and entrepreneurship. Scholars, Practitioners, and Authorities will find the contents useful, and it is also recommended for all postgraduate students in the field of business and entrepreneurship.

Associate Professor Joshua Adewale Adejuwon
Professor Godwin Emmanuel Oyedokun

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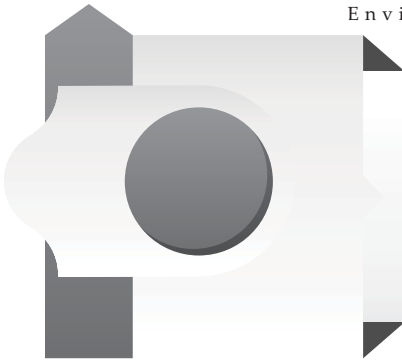
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CHAPTER 13

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Corporate Social Responsibility on Business Growth in Business Environment

AMOO Olatunji Shina & KUJORE Oluwatobi Abodunrin



CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY ON BUSINESS GROWTH IN BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT

CHAPTER 13

**AMOO Olatunji Shina & KUJORE Oluwatobi
Abodunrin**

Abstract

The influence of large and even small business organizations in society has made the issue of corporate social responsibility a very important issue for all business organizations and their stakeholders. Rapid changes in society such as business interactions have led to many changes throughout the social system, and this has caused many problems. The seminar examines and investigates the Impact of Corporate Social Responsibility on Business Growth in Business Environment. The study adopts the quantitative research method through survey research design.

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Keywords: Corporate Social Responsibility, Business Growth, Environment

Introduction

Businesses have been changing in recent years, and they have been required to reconsider their business objectives and operations. Today, new regulations, changes in customer's tastes and preferences, globalization, advanced technological innovations, new product development, and new market competitions, have brought new challenges that organizations must cope with in order to survive and perform effectively for the attainment of business goals and

objectives. As competition among business organizations grows stronger, organizations look forward for ways to gain competitive advantage over their rivals. Organizations are seeking new strategies to ensure their survival and growth in order to achieve certain goals and objectives. Organizations have been trying a few different things recently, including working on corporate social responsibility activities and communicating about them.

In the last few decades, there has been a popular outcry for organizations to be aware of their social responsibilities. Education and increased media awareness have also made CSR difficult to ignore. Corporations use corporate social responsibility as a vital instrument to enhance their marketing image, customer satisfaction and stakeholder's acceptance, and improve long-term performance and business survival. The influence of large and even small business organizations in society has made the issue of corporate social responsibility a very important issue for all business organizations and their stakeholders. Rapid changes in society such as business interactions have led to many changes throughout the social system, and this has caused many problems.

Currently, organizations realize that, in the long run, no social organization, including commercial organizations, can survive for a long time. With increasing attention to environmental challenges and issues related to various products and services, delivery systems are becoming a sensitive business strategy for organizing corporate social responsibility activities to promote socially sensitive corporate images. It is expected and important for organizations to fulfill their expectations and moral obligations at the social level. However, the status and performance of enterprises and the social conditions in which they operate must indicate the extent to which they assume social responsibility to society.

Corporate social responsibility has developed into an indispensable business strategy in the current business environment. It is not enough and acceptable for organizations to produce high-quality products and services and make a profit.

Now they are expected to take responsible actions and establish a positive relationship with the society and environment in which they operate. People have high expectations for the performance of the organization, that is, it is responsible to the society for the stakeholders. In order to do this, managers of commercial organizations began to use their annual reports or their websites as communication tools for voluntary disclosure of some of their social responsibility activities to exchange information about their ethical practices and social responsibilities, in order to create, Develop and promote a friendly and good reputation and a good public image for their organization.

Perhaps many organizations are doing CSR activities, which mean extra expense and wasted financial resources. However, organizations operating in a highly competitive and complex environment can engage corporate social responsibility activities with the goodwill and sponsorship of the general public, attracting existing customers, attracting new customers, and host communities. It is a favorable environment for peaceful coexistence and promotes employee satisfaction in the workplace. The relationship between business and society and between business and its participants is very complex but dynamic. Corporate social responsibility activities can improve efficiency and innovation management by strengthening corporate intangible assets such as reputation, brand, and stakeholder management.

Statement of Problem

Despite the great attention that has recently been given to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) in Nigeria, there is still an area of concern to access the how CSR can affect the growth of business and sustainability of CSR to development of environment. Another area of corporate social responsibility where there is less research is with developing nations. Therefore, this study will the impact of corporate social responsibility on business growth in business environment, problems and prospects of corporate social responsibilities in Nigeria. It is ironic that most organizations take resources from the external environment, and it is

only natural to give back what has been exploited. Unfortunately, this anomaly is a norm in this part of the globe and this cankerworm can only be ameliorated through research, such as this, publication, media publicity, campaigns and awareness emphasizing the importance of corporate social responsibility in our society.

Objectives of the Study

The purpose of this seminar paper can be summarized as follows:

- i. Identify how corporate social responsibility can affect the growth of business.
- ii. Examine the economic, social and environmental factors influencing corporate social responsibility in Nigeria.
- iii. Examine the problem and prospect between corporate social responsibility and business environment.

Research Questions

The following research questions should be considered to obtain an accurate answer to the corporate social responsibility on business growth in business environment:

- i. What are the problem and prospect between corporate social responsibility and business environment?
- ii. Do the economic, social and environmental factors influencing corporate social responsibility in Nigeria?

Hypotheses

The following hypotheses developed are tested to provide answers to the survey questions.

H₀₁: There is no significant correlation between corporate social responsibility and business growth.

H₀₂: There is no significant correlation between economic, social and environmental factors and corporate social responsibility in Nigeria.

Literature Review

Concept of Corporate Social Responsibility

Business and society are interconnected and cannot be separated. Corporate social responsibility is a business obligation, beyond that required by law and economics, to pursue long-term goals that are good for society. The expectation that society in general and social segments in particular have placed on business. It is the intelligent and objective concern for the well-being of society which constrains the behavior of individuals and firms from destructive activities at an inopportune time no matter how profitable they are on the spot and which leads in the direction of positive contributions to human improvement.

Corporate social responsibility is a management obligation to take action to protect and improve both the welfare of society as a whole and, in particular, the interests of the organization and its shareholders. In other words, corporate social responsibility focuses on both organizational success and social welfare. World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBSCSD), corporate social responsibility is the ethical behavior of a company's society, and management may bring legitimate benefits to the business. Act responsibly in relation to one other interested party. It is an ongoing effort by businesses to act ethically, contribute to economic development, and at the same time improve the quality of life for workers and their families, as well as communities and society as a whole. This definition seems to cover all aspects required by stakeholders in corporate social responsibility, because it touches the wishes of all stakeholders. However, it failed to resolve the organization's responsibility to the owner.

Developing CSR for an organization is not an overnight business; CSR is a process that requires an organization to follow the path of working with all stakeholder. Corporate CSR initiatives and effective implementation are no different from quality and may contribute to corporate profitability. An important factor influencing CSR growth is how an organization raises awareness and involves

stakeholders in its CSR activities. Stakeholders can contribute to different aspects and lead to different interests when involved in supporting or participating in a CSR initiative. In addition, stakeholders can have a variety of impacts on the operation of the organization, so stakeholders contribute to key segments that support or ruin CSR initiatives.

Types of Corporate Social Responsibility

1. **The economic responsibility** to make money. Required by simple economics, this obligation is the business version of the human survival instinct. Companies that don't make profits are in a modern market economy doomed to perish. Nonprofit organizations make money (from their own activities as well as through donations and grants), but pour it back into their work. Also, public/private hybrids can operate without turning a profit. In some cities, trash collection is handled by this kind of organization, one that keeps the streets clean without making anyone rich. For the vast majority of operations, however, there have to be profits. Without them, there's no business and no business ethics.
2. **The legal responsibility** to adhere to rules and regulations. This responsibility is not controversial. What proponents of CSR argue, however, is that this obligation must be understood as a proactive duty. That is, laws aren't boundaries that enterprises skirt and cross over if the penalty is low; instead, responsible organizations accept the rules as a social good and make good faith efforts to obey not just the letter but also the spirit of the limits. In concrete terms, this is the difference between the driver who stays under the speed limit because he can't afford a traffic ticket, and one who obeys because society as a whole is served when we all agree to respect the signs and stoplights and limits. Going back to John Travolta racing his Porsche up and down the rural highway, he sensed none of this respect.

3. **The ethical responsibility** to do what's right even when not required by the letter or spirit of the law. This is the theory's keystone obligation, and it depends on a coherent corporate culture that views the business itself as a citizen in society, with the kind of obligations that citizenship normally entails. When someone is racing their Porsche along a country road on a freezing winter's night and encounters another driver stopped on the roadside with a flat, there's a social obligation to do something, though not a legal one. The same logic can work in the corporate world. Many industrial plants produce, as an unavoidable part of their fabricating process, poisonous waste.
4. **The philanthropic responsibility** to contribute to society's projects even when they're independent of the particular business. A lawyer driving home from work may spot the local children gathered around a makeshift lemonade stand and sense an obligation to buy a drink to contribute to the neighborhood project. Similarly, a law firm may volunteer access to their offices for an afternoon every year so some local schoolchildren may take a field trip to discover what lawyers do all day. Instead, these public acts of generosity represent a view that businesses, like everyone in the world, have some obligation to support the general welfare in ways determined by the needs of the surrounding community.

Challenges of Corporate Social Responsibility

Corporations face difficulty in CSR implementation and in its effectiveness. The main reason of challenge in practical work was that CSR requires high cost and corporations' in adequate financial resources to train the staff. It is most commonly understood that the greatest main challenge for implementing and developing CSR were steady competitive tension, inadequate backing from the government and other nongovernment organizations beside the huge cost of implementation. Moreover, lack of support from customers and investors was an additional challenge. Complimenting to these, the core challenge in

implementation of CSR was difficulty in changing traditional business practices to CSR agenda that requires leaders' great commitment in managing and in changing their focus and behavior. Furthermore, the lack of managers' expertise and capability to successfully implement desired changes was also creating challenge in CSR implementation process.

A change is not an easy process and it requires commitment and hard work to make a desired change. It became evident that the changes in developed CSR plans means that they are not easy to administer it and there is also an increasing proof that a basic transformation in the business model cannot happen without a major dedication by the leadership and an alteration in the target area and behavior of leaders. Considering the changes required for effective CSR implementation, it is crucial to follow up on how changes could be most actively done. Past researches indicated that it is not easy to introduce and make change in corporations because of which most of the instructions and ways of change were unsuccessful in brining needed results. However, more current research points out that there are other ways of thinking about and coming to change which is most of the time directs to greater favorable results. Change could be a linear process and should be done from the upper level of corporations and made uniformly across all levels in reference to specific plans.

Business Environment

The environment of a business is the sum of all external and internal conditions and influence patterns that affect the survival, growth and development of the enterprise. Business environment analysis is the inspection and evaluation of the opportunities and threats provided by the environment, as well as the potential advantages and disadvantages of the enterprise. Opportunities and threats are related to the external environment of the company, while strengths and weaknesses are related to the internal environment of the company. Therefore, the external analysis examines the opportunities and threats in the environment, while the internal analysis examines the advantages and disadvantages of the company.

Opportunities and threats exist independently of the company. If there is a problem in the absence of a given business, the problem must be a factor in the external environment; otherwise, it is an internal environmental factor. Alternatively, if the problem coexists with the business, but the business is unable to control or influence the problem, then the problem is an external environmental factor. Opportunities are a favorable condition of the external environment, which can reward an organization if acted properly. That is, they exist, but businesses need to act on them in order to benefit from them. A threat is a condition or barrier that can prevent a business unit from achieving its purpose. Several studies have attempted to analyze or assess the impact of environmental factors on various aspects of a corporate organization. Organizations that recognize the presence and intensity of competition have a greater tendency to seek out information about customers for the purpose of evaluation and to use such information to their advantage.

Environmental Conservation and Organizational Growth

Traditionally, environmental protection has been considered to be “in the public interest” and external to private life. Governments have assumed principal responsibility for assuring environmental management, and have focused on creating and preserving a safe environment. They have directed the private sector to adopt environmentally sound behavior through regulations, sanctions and occasionally, incentives. Environmental problems have arisen, the public sector has generally borne the responsibility for mitigation of environmental damage. However, the roles of sectors have been changing, with the private sector becoming an active partner in environmental protection through CSR adoption. Many governments and businesses are now realizing that environmental protection and economic growth are not always in conflict. Environmental sustainability is an integral part of a sustainable growth strategy. While protection of the environment and economic growth are often seen as competing aims, highlighting the financial benefits of increased eco-efficiency, Akpan (2006) observed that the natural environment is central to economic activity and growth,

providing the resources we need to produce goods and services, and absorbing unwanted processing by-products in form of waste.

Moser and Miller, (2001) observed that the current strength of the arguments for CSR programs are driving companies increasingly towards the adoption of socially and environmentally responsible strategies. There has been much popular discussion of the role of „green investors“ in driving societies to adopt or advocate for environmentally friendly practices (Baron, 2007). Investors allocate their wealth between savings, charitable donations, or shares of a socially responsible firm. If some investors prefer to make their social donations through investing in socially responsible companies (perhaps in order to avoid taxation of corporate profits), then CSR can increase the value of the firm by attracting these investors.

Another way is where companies try to attract and retain the best employees by making environmental commitments that are aligned with these employees“ environmental values. Frank (2003) surveyed Cornell University graduates and found that many are willing to accept substantially lower salaries in firms engaged in socially responsible activities. Dibb, et al., (2012) observed that most companies that are environmentally responsible eventually have enhanced brand image and reputation which generate strategically important goodwill and enhanced customer loyalty from a CSR perspective. Typically, a consumer is drawn to a company and a brand that has a good reputation for providing service and products and delivering value, as defined by the customer. However, they failed to show how gained customer loyalty from CSR activities enhances organization growth. With many key natural resources and ecosystems services scarce or under pressure, achieving sustained growth require absolute decoupling of the production of goods and services from their environmental impacts. Akpan (2006) observed that policies that improve the efficiency with which businesses use resources, such as energy, water and materials, produce not just environmental benefits but also financial savings for businesses.

Additionally, organizations that are committed to CSR have access to socially responsible investment (SRI), where investors take into account considerations such as a company's environmental and socially responsible activities.

Theoretical Review

Economic Theory

According to economic theory, the main goal of a company is to invest funds, allow management to carry out management activities, and use such investment funds to develop social initiatives that may improve the world. To increase profits and bring more profits to shareholders who are prohibited from achieving (Lee 2018). For a sustainable society, we need to not only change our focus from the economic side, but also include the social and environmental aspects. In other words, it's important to look far beyond single revenue. It should include multiple revenues that specifically incorporate social and environmental, commonly referred to as the "triple bottom line," rather than "economical."

Elkington (1997) established the concept of a triple bottom line with respect to economic growth, environmental excellence and social justice, and pointed out that stakeholder dialogue is the main driver of the triple bottom line. Stakeholder theory disagrees with the perspective of CSR's economic theory and coordinates and combines with stakeholders to promote satisfaction and integrity, give companies a positive perception, and create a good corporate image. We advocate the ability of CSR to bring about corporate benefits (Sun & Price 2017) because stakeholders can influence and be influenced by our CSR policy (Córdoba-Pachón et al. 2014).

The idea of involving stakeholders in companies remained a topic of much discussion. The argument that sees stakeholders as a negative force that could slow the work and organizational goals was later changed to the notion that stakeholders are vital for the overall performance and company's success.

Organizations often use the communications with stakeholders to learn about the outside world and try to adopt it. The stakeholders, who are affected by the corporations' business operations, can both directly and indirectly influence the corporations' progress. Even though businesses are meant to make money, businesses are part of a web of social relations and therefore should work with the aggregation of matters and concerns given by different people with different backgrounds and interests.

Business Sustainability Development Theory

Business sustainability has received considerable attention from stakeholders (Enquist et al. 2006). Stakeholders are "groups or individuals who may or may affect the achievement of an organization's goals" (Johnson 2007). Sustainability is the assurance of a company's existence and the efficient use of available resources to continue its business (Wackernagel & Rees 1996, pp.32-40). Milne and Gray (2013) stated that for sustainable business development, companies cannot easily recycle products that could pose a danger to society or to properly dispose of used items to save resources claims that the product needs to be considered. Some scholars have associated sustainable development with the triple bottom line (TBL).

This means that beyond the economic aspect, environment and social aspects need to be recognized and work up on it. Social, environmental, and economic progress are the three building blocks for sustainable growth. 2006). Sustainable development, which is often referred to as "triple bottom line," puts focus on the environment, people, and economic integration when businesses conduct their operations (Elkington 1997, p.1; Schieg 2009). The article considers how to make the decisions in the future be in the best interest of both present and future generations. Preserving and protecting the environment is important for future generations in fulfilling their needs. The two of them were sitting down for dinner when the topic of the night's movie came up. The world is getting more and more crowded. According to the Sustainable Development Solutions Network (2013),

in less than a decade, the global population will grow by 75 million people. So, the triple bottom line (economy, society and environment) is necessary to consider for sustainable business development. This concept requires the participation of all stakeholders at all stages, namely from planning to decision-making and implementation (Ness et al. The film follows the story of a woman who is stalked and tortured by a serial killer, who is eventually caught and put to death.

Empirical Review

Eruemegbe (2015) examined the impact of business environment on organization performance in Nigeria using Union bank of Nigeria. The study relied on questionnaire to generate relevant data out of 39 questionnaires administered on officers in Union Bank of Nigeria, Lagos, only 20 were properly completed and returned. This gave an effective response rate of 51%. The method of data analysis and test of operational hypothesis is nonparametric technique which utilize chi-square statistic. The survey revealed that, among the top ten critical factors (i.e. teamwork, work based on contract, supervision based on leadership by example and provision of equipment) had great effect on motivation as well as impact on productivity. More so communication, love and belongingness, opportunity to undertake challenging task, identification with goal and overtime were among the critical factors.

Summary of Gap

Previous work on the subject had only been limited to the benefits of CSR, on how CSR could be put in business practices as well as its helpfulness to business sustainability when CSR initiatives such as economic, social and environmental aspects are incorporated into the strategic business-planning document. However, past researches had failed to address the challenges faced in implementation of CSR and ways of overcoming those challenges of business growth in Nigeria context. This paper contributes to this research gap that there are several challenges in CSR implementation when CSR is practiced and also approaches that should be considered to overcome the challenges.

Methodology

A research paradigm was considered important in the design and choice of research methodology. A qualitative research approach was chosen to do this research paper. The motive for choosing the qualitative approach is because, corporate social responsibility, primarily centers around business practices and the ways of day to-day operational activities, which requires a researcher to understand the business practices through interviews rather than using quantitative methods. Hence, the qualitative research method looks to be useful and the right approach for this study. Qualitative research approach is suitable when researchers are primarily interested in knowing and understanding of some circumstances or occurrences (Easterby-Smith et al. 2015). A qualitative approach makes significance in bringing out information by allowing the researcher to get more opportunity from the responses obtained by asking relevant questions for better clarifications in order to accomplish the research paper.

Conclusion

In a global entrepreneurial environment, the CSR is gaining more and more significance. The CSR will bring a company adequate benefit only if it prepares and carries out meaningful and credible projects. Credibility of socially liable activities of companies supports in public their individuality, originality, personal involvement and conviction that they take these activities seriously. The public expects socially answerable behaviour from companies. Companies in the hotel industry are aware of the fact that the best marketing results come from satisfying the customer's needs in order to return to their catering and accommodating services and to pass on good references to his/her acquaintances. Public opinion turns against a company which refuses to take on social responsibility and due to negative publicity in the media; a company can quickly lose its position. This is why a number of companies comprehend how important it is to search for and use possibilities that present their social responsibility, whilst at the same time allowing them to gain their set economic objectives

Endnotes

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ABOUT THE BOOK

This book brings together, the ideas of different Scholars, Practitioners, and Authorities concerning the subject matter, Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development. There are 13 chapters which were jointly contributed by 25 scholars in the field with the range of title such as Corporate Social Responsibility and Organizational Survival; Environmental Factors and Performance of Small-Scale Businesses in Shomolu Local Government, Lagos; Government Policies and Entrepreneurial Development in Nigeria; Organizational Culture and Business Performance in the Nigerian Service Sector; Sustainability of Small and Medium Scale Enterprises in Nigeria: The Role of Government Policies; Role of Entrepreneurship in Achieving Economic Growth in Nigeria; Impact of Macroeconomics Fluctuation on the Growth of Small and Medium Scale Businesses in Nigeria; Workforce Diversity and Organisational Productivity in Unilever; Entrepreneurship and Small Business Development in Nigeria; Green Marketing and Environmental Degradation in Lagos State, Nigeria; Environmental Factors and Entrepreneurship Development in Nigeria; Significance of Interest Rate in Bolstering Business Development in Nigeria; and Corporate Social Responsibility on Business Growth in Business Environment. This edited book is an addition to the frontiers of knowledge in business and entrepreneurship. Scholars, Practitioners, and Authorities will find the contents useful, and it is also recommended for all postgraduate students in the field of business and entrepreneurship.



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